

Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

▲ **REUVEN AZAR**

Ambassador of Israel to India

AMBASSADORS' DEBRIEF **Operation Roaring Lion**

WHY ISRAEL STRUCK

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Neutralising Iran benefits everyone: safer shipping, protection for Gulf states and projects like IMEC and stability for India's trade
- Peace is possible only when adversaries abandon the goal of destroying Israel—like peace with Egypt ever since 1978

> The Iranians were about to build about 20,000 ballistic missiles that could obliterate any country in the region

> Toppling the regime in Iran needs economic and diplomatic pressure besides military action, as well as immense courage of the people

AMBASSADORS' DEBRIEF
Operation True Promise



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▶ **MOHAMMAD FATHALI**

Ambassador of the Islamic Republic of Iran to India

WHY IRAN WON'T FALL

> Iran and India have common interests. Any gap in their relationship would be exploited by their enemies. But both countries have the maturity to handle any situation

> We told our neighbours, 'we will not touch you', but what should we do? Schools have been hit by Tomahawk missiles and schoolgirls killed. We will target American bases in neighbouring countries

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Iran managed past crises in West Asia as well as crippling sanctions on it without going to war. It prefers negotiations
- Iran was actually negotiating with the US on many aspects of its nuclear programme and was attacked on a false pretext